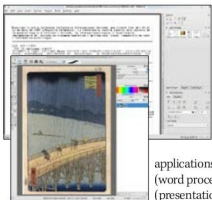


Technology News



KOffice 2.0 debuts with a well thought out UI

Marking the end of more than three years of work to port KOffice to Qt 4 and the KDE4 libraries and, in some cases, totally rewrite the engine of the KOffice applications, the KOffice team has finally announced version 2.0.0 of KOffice. The intention, according to the developers, has been to increase integration between the components of KOffice, decrease duplication of functionality, and ease maintenance and development of new features. Furthermore, new approaches to UI design and interacting with the user have been implemented to support the new capabilities.



The team has claimed that the release is mainly aimed at developers, testers and early adopters.

KOffice 2.0 does not have all the features that KOffice 1.6 had. These features will return in the upcoming versions 2.1 and 2.2, in most cases better implemented and more efficient. Also, not all applications that were part of KOffice 1.6 made it into KOffice 2.0. The missing applications will return in 2.1 or possibly 2.2.

The release team has decided that the following applications are mature enough to be part of 2.0: KWord (word processor), KSpread (spreadsheet), KPresenter (presentation tool), KPlato (project management), Karbon (vector graphics editor) and Krita (raster graphics editor).

Besides this, the chart application KChart is available as a shape plug-in, which means that charts are available in all the KOffice applications in an integrated manner. The desktop database creator Kexi and the formula shape are aimed to be made available in version 2.1.

Time to compile Linux 2.6.30

With the majority of the code enhancements in data storage, Linus Torvalds has released Linux 2.6.30. kernelnewbies.org, and he summarises the release as follows: "This version adds the log-structured NILFS2 filesystem, a filesystem for object-based storage devices, a caching layer for local caching of NFS data, the RDS protocol which delivers high-performance reliable connections between the servers of a cluster, a distributed networking filesystem (POHMEFS), automatic flushing of files on renames/truncates in ext3, ext4 and btrfs, preliminary support for the 802.11w drafts, support for the Microblaze architecture, the Tomoyo security module, DRM support for the Radeon R6xx/R7xx graphic cards, asynchronous scanning of devices and partitions for faster bootup, MD support for switching between raid5/6 modes, the preadv/pwrtv syscalls, several new drivers and many other small improvements."

Citrix delivers XenServer 5.5

Citrix Systems has released Citrix XenServer 5.5. This version adds a wide range of new features that enable easier virtualisation management and broader integration with enterprise systems. It includes features such as consolidated back-up, enhanced conversion and search tools. Active Directory integration and expanded guest support for virtually every version of Windows and Linux. With the new 5.5 release, XenServer provides all the functionality that typically costs up to \$5,000 per server with other leading virtualisation products, for free. Also released is Citrix Essentials 5.5 for XenServer and Hyper-V, providing advanced virtualisation management capabilities for customers using XenServer or Microsoft Hyper-V.

Before Mac/Windows, USB 3.0 comes to Linux

Even before the availability of a USB 3.0 hardware device, it seems that support has been built into the Linux kernel, and will debut with the release of v2.6.31. On June 7, Intel's Sarah Sharp, the chief author of the driver, announced in her blog: "The xHCI (USB 3.0) host controller driver and initial support for USB 3.0 devices is now publicly available on my kernel.org git tree. Greg K-H has queued the patches for 2.6.31, so Linux users should have official USB 3.0 support around September 2009. This is impeccable timing, since NEC recently announced they'll be producing 1 million xHCI PCI express add-in cards in September... I'm working with Kev Gabbert (the OSV person in my group at Intel) to make sure that Linux distributions like Ubuntu and Red Hat pick up the xHCI driver. Advanced users can always compile their own kernel on a standard distro install."

CrossOver 8.0 for Windows apps on Linux

CodeWeavers has announced the release of CrossOver Linux 8.0. CrossOver 8.0 includes support for Internet Explorer 7, Quicken 2009 and performance upgrades for Microsoft Office 2007, particularly Outlook. Another major benefit of CrossOver 8.0 is that recent Wine Project developments have resulted in support for a myriad new applications. CrossOver Linux Standard is priced at \$39.95, and is a download-only product. It is priced at \$69.95, and can be delivered with an optional CD.

